COMPUTER AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY

INTRODUCTION TO COMPUTER AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY

BASIC DEFINITIONS IN ICT

1. *Analogue* – a signal whose value varies continuously over time.
2. *Application* – a computer software program that enable the users to perform specific tasks e.g. Microsoft word.
3. *Back up* – The process of copying your computer files and documents from your hard disk to a removable media or another computer to protect against loss of originals.
4. *Bandwidth* – in computing terms, a measure of maximum amount of data that can be transferred over a connection at any one time.
5. *Binary* – a coding system used by computers and other digital devices to store data as a series of two digits 0 and 1.
6. *BIOS* – Basic input output system. Software built into all PCs to control basic operation of devices such as screen, hard disk and keyboard. When a PC is switched on, BIOS automatically kicks in to look for a drive from which operating system can be launched.
7. *Boot* – The process a PC goes through when it is switched on; performing a quick self test, loading operating system and so on.
8. *Boot disk* – a disk containing operating system components essential to get a PC up and running. Usually the boot disk in a computer is a hard disk but in times of strife, a suitably prepared floppy disk can be used.
9. *Broadband* – A high speed Internet connection.
10. *Browser* – A short name for web browser, an application program that lets you view pages on Internet e.g. Internet explorer.
11. *Clock speed* – The speed of a computer's processor.
12. *Code* – In computing terminology, short for program code, means instructions that are intended to be executed by a computer.
13. *Configure* – Tweak the functions of a software or hardware to a particular setting you require.

14. *CPU* – Central processing unit or processor, the heart of a computer.
15. *Data rate* – The speed at which digital information is transferred from one device to another.
16. *Database* – Any collection of information usually (but not always) used to refer to information stored in a computer. Database software applications usually include powerful search and data filtering facilities.
17. *Digital* – Consist of discrete parts unlike analog signal which consist of continuous parts.
18. *Directory* – Old name for what we now call folders. They provide a way of organizing files and documents on a disk by grouping related items.
19. *DOS* – Disk operating system.
20. *Download* – Process of transferring files on to your computer direct from another computer
21. *Driver* – Software needed to allow (Windows and other operating systems) to communicate with a peripheral.
22. *E – Commerce* – Financial transaction over Internet.
23. *Email* – Electronic mail, a system of sending notes and memos between computers via Internet.
24. *Encryption* – The science of scrambling data so that it can only be read by authorized senders and receivers.
25. *Executable file* – these are launchable programs which have a file extension .exe. Clicking on an executable file will start it running. Avoid launching .exe email attachments as they may carry computer viruses.
26. *Extension* – Three letter code at the end of filename that indicate the type or format of the file.
27. *Firewall* – A system that prevents unauthorized access to a computer over network.
28. *Format* – The process of preparing a floppy disk or hard disk for use with a particular computer and operating system.
29. *Freeware* – Software which is free for you to keep and use.
30. *FTP* – File transfer protocol which is a way of transferring files over Internet.
31. *Full duplex* – The ability of a device to send and receive data simultaneously.

32. *Hard disk* – A high capacity disk fitted into almost all PCs used to store applications and documents and files they create.
33. *Hardware* – Your computer is split up into two parts: hardware and software. Hardware describes physical components such as keyboard and monitor.
34. *HTML (hypertext markup language)* – The language used to create web pages for a website.
35. *Internet* – A global network that links millions of computers using phones and cable links.
36. *LAN (local area network)* – Two or more computers connected, either physically or wirelessly, with ability to share resources such as printers.
37. *Memory (or RAM)* – Random access memory is a computer's temporary storage area, anything written to RAM will be lost when a computer is switched off.
38. *MODEM* – A device that enables two computers to communicate with each other over a telephone line.
39. *Modulation* – A way of varying aspects of a wave.
40. *Motherboard* – The main circuit board inside any PC into which other components connect and communicate through.
41. *Network* – A way of connecting several computers and printers so that they can share data.
42. *Online* – Being connected to Internet.
43. *Operating system* – Operating system governs the way software and hardware components in a computer works together, e.g. Windows, Mac OSx, Linux, Unix.
44. *Processor* – The chip that is the brain of the computer.
45. *Program* – Software or applications which tells your computer and its accessories what to do and how to do it.
46. *Reboot* – To restart a computer.
47. *ROM (read only memory)* – Any memory that can be read but cannot be written to. BIOS uses ROM.
48. *Router* – A device which is used to connect more than one computer together or to Internet as an alternative to MODEM.
49. *Search engine* – A site on Internet that indexes the names and addresses of other sites.

50. *Server* – A computer on a network that stores shared information.
51. *Software* – Any program which tells the software how it should perform.
52. *Spreadsheet* – A software application for creating sheets of calculations, set out in rows and columns.
53. *System Software* – Controls the hardware and manages applications on your PC.
54. *TCP/IP* – Transmission control protocol / Internet protocol. The protocol used to transfer data and information from one Internet connected computer to another.
55. *Traffic* – Amount of information being carried by a communication device (usually the Internet) at any one time.
56. *Video conferencing* – Linking two or more PCs to capture and display video in real time so that distant people can see as well as talk to each other.
57. *Website* – A collection of web pages on Internet.